Ardmore Parish Newsletter

Twenty-Ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

Sunday, 18th October 2026

✝️ Gospel Reflection (Matthew 22:15–21)

In today's gospel, religious leaders try to trap Jesus with a question about paying taxes to Caesar. Pointing to the coin's image and inscription, He teaches us to fulfil our earthly responsibilities while giving our deepest allegiance to God.

Jesus reminds us that not every question deserves a fight. What matters is whether our choices reflect goodness, truth, and love, drawing us closer to God, strengthening our character, and blessing others. A life well lived is measured not by arguments won, but by faithfulness to God's will.

The coin carried Caesar's image, reminding us to respect legitimate laws, perform our duties honestly, support our families, and contribute positively to society. Faith does not excuse us from responsible citizenship; it inspires us to fulfil our duties with sincerity and fairness.

The coin bore Caesar's image, but our lives are called to reflect God's goodness. Though we cannot do so perfectly every day, we can choose to grow: let our words encourage, our hands help, and our hearts forgive.

We may give money to the world, time to our responsibilities, and attention to our ambitions, but we must give God what belongs to Him: our love, worship, gratitude, trust, and obedience. Our relationship with God remains the foundation of a meaningful life.

We may carry coins in our pockets, but we carry God's calling in our hearts. Give the world your honest service, others your genuine love, and God your whole heart. That is how an ordinary life becomes a beautiful offering to Him.

🌎 World Mission Sunday

October has been the month of universal mission since 1926. Mission Sunday invites Catholics to unite with missionaries worldwide and recommit to the Church's missionary activity through prayer, sacrifice and financial support.

Funds help young churches and missionaries serve communities in need, both spiritually and materially. Contributions build mission churches, educate seminarians, form catechists and lay leaders, fund children's health clinics, provide emergency aid in war or disaster, and help missionaries care for refugees.

This year's theme is **'One in Christ, united in mission'.**

Today we celebrate our approximately 1,500 Irish-born missionaries and all missionaries worldwide, thanking God for them, for those who support them at home, and for our growing communion with them and the communities they serve.

To read Pope Leo's message for World Mission Sunday, please visit the official World Mission Sunday 2026 message.

📖 Readings for Sunday, 25th October

- **First Reading:** Exodus 22:20–26
- **Psalm:** Psalm 18:2–3, 3–4, 47, 51
- **Second Reading:** 1 Thessalonians 1:5c–10
- **Gospel:** Matthew 22:34–40

🙏 Saints of the Coming Week

Monday, 19th October

- St John de Brébeuf, St Isaac Jogues, priests and companions, martyrs
- St Paul of the Cross, priest

Thursday, 22nd October

- St John Paul II, Pope

Friday, 23rd October

- St John of Capistrano, priest

Saturday, 24th October

- St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

🕊️ Annual Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing

Sunday, 15th November 2026 – Silver Birch Hotel, Omagh

The Annual Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing takes place on Sunday, 15th November, in the Silver Birch Hotel, Omagh.

Registration begins at **9.30am**, with the day concluding with the celebration of Mass and a Healing Service in the afternoon.

Guest Speaker: Fr John Keane
Theme: 'People of God's Delight' (Psalm 149:4)

The day is organised by the Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group, which celebrates its 50th anniversary.

All welcome.

💍 ACCORD Derry – Marriage Preparation Courses

ACCORD Derry has announced the following Marriage Preparation Course dates for 2027:

- 29th–30th January
- 19th–20th February
- 19th–20th March

Courses take place in person at the **Everglades Hotel, Derry**.

Bookings are now available.

Website: www.accordni.com

📿 Global Rosary for Peace

Thursday, 22nd October – 3.00pm (GMT)

Join hundreds of thousands of Catholics around the world praying for peace in the tradition of Venerable Patrick Peyton.

The Global Rosary for Peace takes place on the Feast of St John Paul II.

Visit *Pray for Peace – HCFM* to register and watch the event live.

🏡 Fatima Pilgrimage 2027

A pilgrimage to Fatima, led by spiritual director **Fr Sean O'Donnell**, departs on 5th July 2027.

Pilgrimage Details:

- Seven nights, full board
- Accommodation at Hotel Cinquentenario

- Cost: £950 per person sharing
- £100 discount if paid in full by 30th November 2026

For further information, please contact:

Patricia: 07743 936548
Anne: 07784 953408

📚 Book of Memories – Father Paddy O'Kane

A new book is being planned about the well-known Derry priest, **Fr Paddy O'Kane**, who died in 2022.

Due for publication next year, the book will include memories and stories from those who knew him, alongside selections from his Derry News column.

Anyone who has a memory or story to share is warmly invited to contact the author, Ciaran O'Neill.

Email: caoneill1971@gmail.com
Telephone: 07875 904354

🙏 Pray for Vocations

What does God want you to be?

If you feel you may have a vocation to serve as a priest of the Derry Diocese, please contact your local priest or the Diocesan Vocations Director:

Fr Pat O'Hagan
Telephone: 028 7938 6259
Email: pgoh2111@gmail.com

Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours

The next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours will take place on:

- Tuesday, 20th October
- Tuesday, 3rd November
- Tuesday, 1st December

Time: 8.00pm–9.00pm, following 7.30pm Mass
Venue: St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry

Everyone welcome.

🌸 Abide Women's Conference

20th–22nd November 2026 – Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran

The Abide Women's Conference takes place at the Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran.

Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and the Nashville Dominicans.

Mass will be celebrated by **Bishop Fintan Gavin**, Diocese of Cork and Ross.

For further information and registration, please visit *Abide in His Love* on Eventbrite.ie.

💔 **Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend**

Friday, 9th – Sunday, 11th April 2027

A Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend will take place at **St Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo**.

This residential weekend is open to all married couples and offers an opportunity to strengthen and enrich their marriage.

The weekend begins at 7.30pm on Friday and concludes at 4.30pm on Sunday.

Booking: Online only at www.marriageencounter.ie

🕯️ **Solemn Novena of Healing – St Columba's Church, Long Tower**

A Solemn Novena of Healing in honour of **Our Lady of Perpetual Help**, and to celebrate the Jubilee of St Francis of Assisi, will take place at St Columba's Church, Long Tower, Derry.

The Novena will be held over the nine Sundays before Christmas, beginning:

Sunday, 25th October at 6.00pm

A guest speaker will attend each week.

Everyone welcome.

🌟 **Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community**

Derry Youth Ministry invites young adults aged **18–35** to become part of its new diocesan community.

Meetings take place every Tuesday evening at **7.30pm**, beginning 20th October, at **Claudy Pastoral Centre**.

Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food and fellowship, alongside organised social events.

Everyone is welcome to come along.

Further information: yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org

📿 **Rosary on the Coast**

Sunday, 18th October – 3.00pm

Rosary on the Coast takes place at **Benone Strand**, with prayers offered for peace, Ireland and unborn babies.

Everyone is warmly invited to attend.

🕊️ **A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett**

Friday, 6th – Sunday, 8th November 2026

A special weekend retreat with Sr Clare Crockett will take place at **Termonbacca, Derry**.

The retreat offers an opportunity for prayer, reflection and learning more about the life and faith of Sr Clare.

Email: termonbaccderry@ocd.ie

Further information is available through Termonbacca Derry on Facebook.

Ardmore Parish

United in faith, prayer and community.

May God bless all our parishioners and their families throughout the coming week.